

PROJECT REPORT OF INDUSTRY ORIENTED HANDS ON EXPERIENCE (IOHE)
ON

Economic Growth and Inclusive Development

submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of degree of

BACHELOR OF ENGINEERING

In

COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

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DECLARATION

I hereby certify that the work which is being presented in the project report entitled “**Economic Growth and Inclusive Development**” in partial fulfilment of requirement for the award of the degree of Bachelor of Engineering (Computer Science and Engineering) submitted in the department of Computer Science and Engineering at Chitkara University Institute of Engineering and Technology, Chitkara University, Punjab, India, is an authentic record of my own work carried out under the supervision of Dr. Monika. The matter presented in this project report has not been submitted in any other university/institute for the award of any degree.

Place: Rajpura

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This is to certify that the above statement made by the candidate is correct to the best of my knowledge and belief.

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Lastly, I would like to thank my family and friends for their continuous support and motivation.

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Fig. 1: Conceptual Framework of Economic Growth

Fig. 2: Lewis Model of Structural Transformation

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Abstract

This research study critically examines the changing nature of economic growth and highlights the growing importance of developing a model that ensures inclusivity, employment generation, and environmental sustainability. Traditional economic theories predominantly emphasized industrialization as the central driver of economic development, often treating agriculture as a secondary or transitional sector. However, the limitations of such models have become increasingly evident in the contemporary global economic scenario.

The study identifies two major challenges associated with modern growth patterns: the problem of unemployment due to capital-intensive technologies and automation, and the issue of environmental degradation resulting from unsustainable resource use. These challenges have led to the emergence of jobless growth and increased inequality, especially in developing economies like India.

The paper further explores the interdependence between agriculture, industry, and services, emphasizing the need for a balanced development approach. It highlights the evolving role of agriculture not only as a source of food and employment but also as a driver of sustainability and economic resilience.

The findings of the study suggest that agriculture-led growth, when strategically supported and complemented by industrial and service-sector development, provides a more inclusive and sustainable pathway for economic transformation. The study concludes by advocating for a new integrated growth paradigm that aligns economic progress with social equity and environmental sustainability.

Introduction

Economic development has traditionally been understood as a process of structural transformation in which resources shift from low-productivity sectors, such as agriculture, to higher-productivity sectors like industry and services. Classical economic theories emphasized industrialization as the main engine of growth, assuming that agriculture would gradually lose its importance as economies develop.

However, this traditional perspective has undergone significant changes in recent decades. The global economy has witnessed several challenges that question the effectiveness of conventional growth models. One of the most critical issues is the increasing disconnect between economic growth and employment generation. Rapid technological advancement, automation, and capital-intensive production methods have reduced the capacity of industry to absorb labor, leading to widespread unemployment and underemployment.

At the same time, environmental concerns such as climate change, water scarcity, land degradation, and pollution have emerged as major constraints to sustainable development. The excessive use of natural resources and environmentally harmful practices have created long-term risks for both economic stability and human well-being.

In this changing context, agriculture is re-emerging as a vital sector in economic development. It not only provides employment to a large proportion of the population but also contributes to food security, poverty reduction, and environmental sustainability. Moreover, agriculture plays a critical role in creating linkages with industry and services by generating demand for inputs, supporting agro-based industries, and boosting rural consumption.

Therefore, the present study aims to critically examine the need for a new development model that integrates agriculture with industry and services. It seeks to highlight how a balanced, inclusive, and sustainable growth strategy can address the contemporary challenges of employment, inequality, and environmental degradation.

Methodology

Research Design

The study follows a descriptive and analytical research design, which helps in understanding complex relationships between different sectors of the economy and evaluating the effectiveness of various growth models.

Nature of Study

This research is analytical in nature, focusing on:

- Sectoral growth patterns
- Employment trends
- Environmental sustainability

It aims to provide conceptual clarity and policy-oriented insights rather than purely quantitative conclusions.

Sources of Data

The study is entirely based on secondary data, collected from reliable and authentic sources such as:

- Published research journals and academic articles
- Government reports like Economic Surveys
- Data from institutions such as NITI Aayog
- Books and policy papers on economic development

These sources provide both qualitative explanations and quantitative insights into economic growth patterns.

Scope of Study

The research mainly focuses on:

- The Indian economy
- Sectoral composition (Agriculture, Industry, Services)
- Employment generation
- Sustainability and resource utilization

Analytical Framework

The study uses the following approaches:

- Conceptual analysis of development theories
- Comparative analysis across sectors and regions
- Logical interpretation of economic patterns

Limitations

- Reliance on secondary data limits real-time accuracy
- Lack of primary surveys restricts ground-level insights
- No advanced econometric modeling used

Tools and Technologies

Although the research is theoretical in nature, several tools and techniques have been utilized to carry out the study effectively:

Data Collection Tools

- Government databases and open data portals
- Academic journals and digital libraries

Analytical Techniques

- Comparative analysis of sectoral growth
- Trend analysis of economic patterns
- Conceptual modeling

Visualization Tools

- Graphs and charts to represent trends
- Conceptual diagrams (e.g., Lewis Model, growth phases)

Documentation Tools

- Microsoft Word for report preparation
- PDF tools for formatting and submission

These tools collectively helped in organizing, analyzing, and presenting the research data in a structured form.

Implementation/ Analysis

The study implements a structured approach to analyze economic growth:

Sectoral Contribution Analysis

- Agriculture remains a major employer
- Industry contributes significantly to GDP
- Services dominate economic output but lack employment capacity

Growth Phases in India

- **Agricultural Phase:** Green Revolution improved productivity
- **Industrial Phase:** Liberalization boosted manufacturing
- **Service Phase:** IT and finance sectors expanded

Inter-sector Linkages

- Agriculture provides raw materials to industries
- Industry supplies inputs like machinery
- Services facilitate trade, logistics, and finance

Sustainability Analysis

The study highlights:

- Environmental degradation caused by unsustainable practices
- Need for eco-friendly agricultural methods
- Importance of resource conservation

Results and Findings

Agriculture as a Key Growth Driver

Agriculture plays a crucial role in:

- Employment generation
- Poverty reduction
- Demand creation for other sectors

Jobless Growth

Modern growth is characterized by:

- High output but low job creation
- Increased automation and reduced labor demand

Income Inequality

- Rural vs urban income gap
- High disparity across sectors
- Service-led growth benefits limited population

Environmental Issues

- Resource depletion (water, soil)
- Pollution due to fertilizers and chemicals
- Climate change impacts

Structural Imbalance

- Uneven development across sectors
- Weak coordination between economic sectors

Conclusion and Future Scope

The study concludes that traditional economic models focusing solely on industrialization are no longer adequate in addressing modern challenges. There is a clear need for a shift towards a more inclusive and sustainable development strategy.

Agriculture must be recognized as a central component of economic growth due to its:

- Employment potential
- Contribution to food security
- Role in environmental sustainability

A balanced approach that integrates agriculture, industry, and services is essential for achieving long-term economic stability and social equality.

- The study can be extended in the following areas:
 - State-wise growth comparison
 - Use of primary data collection
 - Integration of AI and technology in agriculture
 - Development of sustainable farming policies

References

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Appendices

- Graphs and charts
- Models and frameworks
- Additional analysis data

